Alexander Dao

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Education

University of California, Santa Cruz — **Santa Cruz**
Linguistics Major, Computer Science Minor — **Winter 2027**

Thesis:
The Visual Word Form Area, Autism, and Childhood Hyperlexia

Relevant Coursework:
CSE 13S (C Programming)
CSE 40 (Machine Learning in Python)
CSE 101 (Introduction to Data Structures and Algorithms)
CSE 150 (Introduction to Computer Networks)
CSE 151 (Advanced Computer Networks)

Experience

treemarks.ai — **Stanford**
Intern Software Engineer — **Jul 2026 - Present**

- Currently developing a streamlined, configurable AI shell for TA workflows by adapting an existing Claude-based grading agent and implementing core features for practical deployment.

The American Prospect — **Santa Cruz**
Intern Contributor, Tech Beat — **Dec 2025 - May 2026**

- Responsibilities included research, fact-checking, social media, data entry, and library services.
- Primary role expectations were editorial contributions, writing briefs and articles as assigned, generating story ideas, and pursuing individual projects with minimal staff guidance.
- Daily responsibilities included technical research, fact-checking, and data entry related to emerging AI technologies.

Paystand — **Santa Cruz**
Content Analytics Intern — **Jun 2024 – Jan 2025**

- Developed essential data entry and analytics skills, worked cross-departmentally with marketing and the CEO's office.
- Shadowed engineering, product, network infrastructure, and sales personnel in their day-to-day work.
- Tracked social metrics and analyzed platform growth for C-suite to improve community engagement with the company using Google Sheets/Excel.

Additional Experience

Project: SpotiLytics — **Mountain View**
Data Engineer — **Jun 2026 – Present**

- Joint statistics modeling project by Alexander Dao and Jack Rudy. Currently in development.
- The aim of this project is to understand whether we can predict songs listened to on a given day of the week, using various classifier models to analyze previous user Spotify listening behavior.
- The project uses a Python (Flask and SpotiPy) back end to handle Spotify JSON data with some vanilla JS for handling front-end integration with our static webpage. Future incarnations will fully migrate to a JS-based framework for more secure and scalable authentication as well as data retrieval.

Independent Contractor **Menlo Park**
Low Voltage Technician Apprentice **Jun 2023 – Aug 2023**

- Assisted with residential and commercial low-voltage cabling installation.
- Pulled, routed, and terminated structured cabling under supervision.
- Supported installation of networking, AV, and security wiring systems.

Sailing Instructor **Redwood City**
Peninsula Youth Sailing Foundation **May 2021 – Sep 2021**

- Primarily worked on the Editorial beat and supervised under a senior student editor.
- Leveraged Adobe Creative Suite and Google Suite to create short and long-form pieces, including a 2021 Capitol Hill piece and a collaborative behind-the-scenes audit of the school district's IT department.

Student Broadcaster **Mountain View**
New Media Lit **Aug 2020 – Jun 2021**

- Primarily worked on the Editorial beat and supervised under a senior student editor.
- Leveraged Adobe Creative Suite and Google Suite to create short and long-form pieces, including a 2021 Capitol Hill piece and a collaborative behind-the-scenes audit of the school district's IT department.

Leadership & Activities

Math, Engineering & Science Achievement Program (MESA) **Santa Cruz**
Member **Feb 2025 - Present**

- Joint peer and staff-led mathematics, engineering, and sciences club @ UC Santa Cruz. Supports achievement for under-represented first-generation college students.

Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers (SHPE) **Santa Cruz**
Member **Sep 2025 - Jun 2026**

- Society of engineers from all Hispanic backgrounds, affiliated with clubs such as the National Society of Black Engineers (NSBE) and MESA.
- There is no requirement to be of Hispanic background; was invited by several friends including club officers and the (former) co-presidents.

Peninsula Youth Sailing Foundation (PYSF) **Santa Cruz**
C420 Race Team Skipper **Jan 2016 - Jan 2022**

- Former competitive dinghy racer with Peninsula Youth Sailing Foundation in both crew and skipper roles. Competed and trained with national and world-title level sailors in local club events, as well as in state-wide PCISA regattas.
- Trained under former two-time world Snipe/Elliott 6m-class champion Molly O'Brien Vandemoer and 2008 470-class Olympic bronze medalist Udi Gal.

Skills & Interests

Technical: C, Python, TypeScript/JS, HTML, CSS
Language: English, Vietnamese, Japanese, Latin, Spanish (basic)
Laboratory: Psycholinguistics, Neurolinguistics, Advanced Computer Networking
Interests: Sketching, Cycling, Sailing, Hiking,